INTERNAL SYSTEMS AUDIT

Booking, Custom Request & Agent Lead Workflow Audit

A benchmark review of Safari Zangu Ventures' three customer-acquisition pipelines against standard DMC/tour-operator workflow conventions — what each flow does today, where it diverges from a correctly-functioning pipeline, and what that costs in lost commissions, silent data loss, and inconsistent client documents.

Scope

Direct booking · Custom request · Agent lead creation · Email/PDF delivery

Method

Full code trace, file:line cited

Date

2 October 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Three Pipelines, One Pattern of Gaps

Safari Zangu Ventures has three distinct ways a prospective client enters the sales funnel — booking a package directly, submitting a custom safari request, or being entered manually by an agent as a lead. All three are built on the same underlying Quotation → Booking → Invoice engine, and that shared core is genuinely solid: the PDF generation, pricing engine, and payment-triggered invoicing built this session work correctly and consistently. The problem is everything *feeding into* that core. The direct-booking path is well-built end to end. The other two have the same underlying defect: the system already stores the data needed to keep a request or lead's status in sync with what actually happened to it — but nothing ever reads that data back. The result is state that only updates when a human remembers to update it by hand, and in the agent-lead path specifically, a confirmed bug that silently drops data on every manually-created lead, plus a complete commission and agent-notification pipeline that exists in the codebase but is wired to nothing.

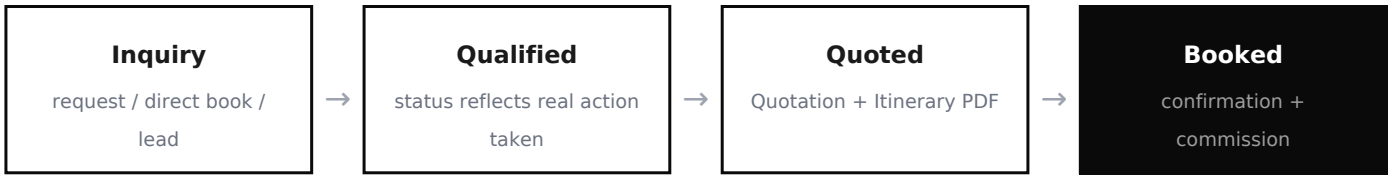
DIRECT BOOKING	CUSTOM REQUEST	AGENT LEAD CREATION	EMAIL / PDF DELIVERY
Correct	**Partial**	**Broken**	**Inconsistent**
Quotation + Itinerary PDFs sent automatically, reminders scheduled, pricing engine authoritative. No structural fix needed.	Submission captured correctly, but status advances itself when a page loads, and never advances when a quotation is actually created from it.	A confirmed schema mismatch on every manual lead save. The commission + agent-notification logic that should fire on conversion is built but disconnected from the live page.	Strong where it matters most (booking, invoice). Thin at the edges — acceptance, reminders, and agent-facing emails carry no documents at all.

This report is organized around the three entry flows, then a single email/PDF delivery matrix covering all of them, then a prioritized remediation list ordered by what's actually losing the business money or data today versus what's a polish item.

BENCHMARK

What "Correct" Is Measured Against

Tour-operator and DMC booking platforms — the category Safari Zangu Ventures' own admin panel already names itself after (Quotation, Itinerary, Booking Confirmation, Invoice, Voucher are all standard documents in this category, not invented ones) — converge on the same shape regardless of vendor:



The single rule that makes this model work in practice is that **status is a read, not a write** — a pipeline stage should reflect what the system already knows happened (a quotation exists, it was accepted, a booking was created from it), not require a human to separately remember to update a dropdown every time they take an action elsewhere. Every gap identified in this report is a version of that same rule being violated: the data to know better already exists in the database, and nothing reads it.

FLOW 1 OF 3

Customer Direct Booking

`api/book.php` — a customer books a package straight from the public site.

STEP 1

Booking submitted

Package + travel date + party size posted. If the package has a linked itinerary, `ItineraryQuoteBuilder::build()` prices it for the exact party (not a flat per-pax rate) and a real `quotations` row is created as a priced snapshot of what was charged.

STEP 2

Reminders scheduled

`BookingReminderScheduler::schedule()` queues five future emails: deposit due (+48h), balance due (T-45d), departure (T-7d), post-trip (+3d), win-back (+180d).

STEP 3

Confirmation sent — correctly, as two documents

The customer receives **Quotation PDF + Itinerary PDF** as separate attachments on the `booking_confirmation` email, generated fresh from the real party size and dates. This is the one flow in the system where document delivery is fully correct.

Assessment

No structural defect found in this flow. The only gap worth naming is shared with every reminder in the system — see Finding E in the delivery matrix section — and is a polish item, not a correctness bug.

FLOW 2 OF 3

Customer Custom Request

`api/custom_safari.php` → `admin/custom_requests.php` — a customer describes a trip that doesn't match an existing package.

STEP 1

Request submitted

Saved to `custom_safari_requests`, status `new`. Customer gets an acknowledgement email; admin gets a notification email. Neither carries any document — reasonable at this stage, since nothing has been priced yet.

STEP 2 — WHERE IT DIVERGES

Status advances itself, without anyone doing anything

Every time `admin/custom_requests.php`'s list view loads with no filters applied, it bulk-updates every `new` row to `in_review` and stamps `first_response_at` — a field the dashboard's own response-time metric relies on to measure how fast staff actually respond. A page load is not a response. This was already surfaced once this session (the response-time cards were removed from the dashboard for being unreliable); this is the root cause.

STEP 3

Admin builds a quotation

"+ Quote" opens `quotation_new.php?from_request=<id>`, which correctly stores `quotations.custom_request_id` on save — the link back to the originating request exists in the data.

STEP 4 — WHERE IT DIVERGES AGAIN

The request's own status never moves

`custom_safari_requests.status` stays wherever it was left — nothing writes `quoted` when the quotation above is created, and nothing writes `converted` if it becomes a booking. The status dropdown is the only thing that ever changes it, and that's a manual action most admins will forget to take once the quotation itself is underway.

Correct Flow

The fix is small because the hard part — the FK linkage — already exists:

- **Replace the page-load auto-transition** with a real action — status moves to `in_review` when staff actually open the request (e.g. the View action), not when the list renders.
- **Write `quoted` back automatically** the moment a quotation is saved with `custom_request_id` set — one `UPDATE` statement in `quotation_new.php`'s existing save path.
- **Write `converted` back automatically** when that quotation becomes a real booking, mirroring the same pattern already used for `quotations.booking_ref`.

FLOW 3 OF 3

Agent Lead Creation

`admin/leads.php` — an agent manually logs a lead, either against a real package or against "Custom Safari."

CRITICAL

Every manually-created lead writes to a column that doesn't exist

The "+ Add Lead" form's Package Interest field is saved as `package_interest` (`admin/leads.php` lines 28, 43, 397). The `leads` table has no such column in either schema definition on file — only `package_name`. This is not a new finding: it was already flagged and explicitly deferred during this session's earlier remediation work, and has not been fixed since. Every agent who fills in that dropdown and submits is either silently losing that field or, depending on how the dynamic `INSERT` behaves against an unknown column, risking the whole lead failing to save.

`admin/leads.php:28, 43, 397 — leads table schema: sql/baseline_schema.sql:282-316`

> Fix: rename the form field and the insert key to `package_name`, matching the column that actually exists.

CRITICAL

The conversion automation exists — in a file nothing calls

There are two separate implementations of lead-stage updates. The one wired to the live "+ Add Lead" page (`admin/leads.php`'s own inline `update_stage` handler) does nothing beyond writing the new stage. A second, more complete implementation sits in `api/leads.php`: when a lead's stage is set to `booked`, it computes the agent's commission from their on-file rate, creates the `commissions` row, and emails the agent a `lead_converted` notification. Nothing in the admin panel calls this file — it isn't linked from any page or script. In practice, today, when an agent's lead actually converts into a booking through the real UI, **no commission record is created and the agent is never told they converted a sale**, unless a second person separately creates the commission row on `admin/commissions.php` by hand.

`admin/leads.php:56-76 (live, no automation) vs api/leads.php:102-159 (complete, unreferenced)`

> Fix: port the commission-creation and notification logic from `api/leads.php` into the live handler in `admin/leads.php`, then retire `api/leads.php` so there is one implementation, not two that disagree.

HIGH

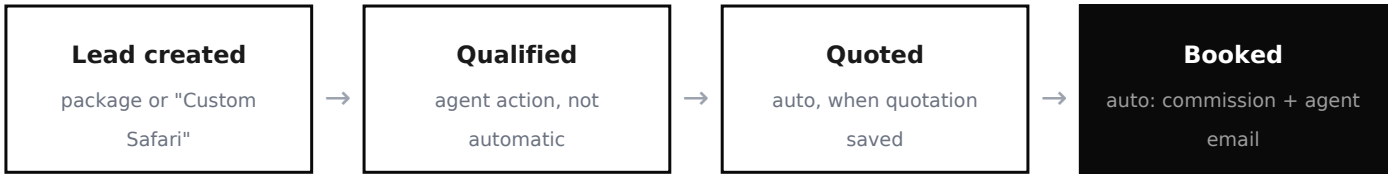
Lead → quotation link exists in the data, same gap as custom requests

`quotations.lead_id` is correctly populated when a quotation is built from `?from_lead=<id>`, but exactly as with custom requests, nothing reads it back — a lead's `pipeline_stage` doesn't advance to `quoted` when that quotation is created, or to `booked` when it converts.

`admin/quotation_new.php:266 (writes lead_id) — nothing reads it back`

> Fix: same pattern as Flow 2 — write the stage forward automatically at each of those two moments instead of leaving it to the status dropdown.

Correct Flow



Note that a lead created against "Custom Safari" and one created against a real package should not need two different code paths — `quotation_new.php` already handles both cases (linked itinerary vs. a freehand Day-by-Day build) once a quotation is actually started. The distinction only matters at creation time, in which dropdown value gets stored; everything downstream is already unified.

DELIVERY AUDIT

Every Automated Email, What It Attaches

All sixteen email trigger points in the system, traced to their call site. Every row is also CC'd to the shared admin inbox unconditionally — see the finding below the table.

TRIGGER	RECIPIENT	ATTACHMENTS TODAY	SHOULD CARRY
Direct booking confirmed	Customer	✓ Quotation + Itinerary PDF	No change
Quotation converted to booking	Customer	✓ Quotation + Itinerary PDF	No change
Admin resends booking confirmation	Customer	✓ Quotation + Itinerary PDF	No change
Quotation emailed to client	Customer	✓ Quotation + Itinerary PDF	No change
Payment reaches fully paid	Customer	✓ Invoice + Itinerary PDF	No change
Voucher emailed	Customer	✓ Voucher PDF	No change
Custom request submitted	Customer	— none	None needed — nothing priced yet
Contact form submitted	Customer	— none	None needed
Quotation accepted	Customer	**✗ none**	Quotation PDF — they just agreed to specific pricing and get no copy of what they accepted
Quotation expired	Customer	— none	None needed
Commission approved	Agent	— none	Low priority — a statement PDF is a nice-to-have, not urgent
Commission paid	Agent	— none	Low priority, same as above
Deposit due reminder	Customer	— none	None needed — payment instructions, not documents
Balance due reminder	Customer	— none	None needed

TRIGGER	RECIPIENT	ATTACHMENTS TODAY	SHOULD CARRY
Departure reminder (T-7 days)	Customer	✗ **none**	Itinerary PDF — the standard "here are your final travel documents" moment in every comparable system
Post-trip / win-back reminders	Customer	— none	None needed
Lead converted (dead code — see Flow 3)	Agent	— n/a, never fires	Fix the trigger first (Flow 3 finding)

MEDIUM

Every single automated email CCs the shared admin inbox, forever

`Mailer::sendRow()` unconditionally CCs `ADMIN_EMAIL` on every email the system sends — deposit reminders, balance reminders, departure reminders, win-back emails, invoices, all of it, with no way to turn it off per template. This works today at low volume. It does not scale: as booking volume grows, the admin inbox becomes a mirror of every transactional email the business sends, with no way to distinguish "needs my attention" from "just a routine reminder that went out fine."

`app/Mail/Mailer.php:218`

> Fix: route internal awareness through the notification system already built in the admin panel (the bell icon added this session) for genuinely actionable events — new bookings, new requests, new leads — and drop the blanket CC on routine/scheduled sends like reminders.

ACTION PLAN

Prioritized Remediation

PRIORITY	ITEM	WHY THIS ORDER
CRITICAL	Fix `package_interest` → `package_name` column mismatch in lead creation	Live data loss or insert failures, happening on every manually-created lead right now
CRITICAL	Reconnect commission creation + agent notification to the live lead conversion path	Agents are not being paid or told automatically when their own leads convert — a revenue-trust issue, not just a UX gap

PRIORITY	ITEM	WHY THIS ORDER
HIGH	Auto-advance lead & custom-request status from the existing `lead_id` / `custom_request_id` links	The data already exists; this closes the gap between "what the system knows" and "what the status field says" across both flows at once
HIGH	Stop auto-setting `in_review` / `first_response_at` on page load	Currently makes the response-time metric meaningless and already caused its removal from the dashboard this session
MEDIUM	Attach Itinerary PDF to the T-7-day departure reminder	Standard practice elsewhere; customers expect final documents close to travel
MEDIUM	Attach Quotation PDF to the quotation-accepted email	Customer has no record of exactly what they agreed to otherwise
MEDIUM	Move internal awareness off blanket admin CC onto the notification bell	Scaling risk, not an active bug today — fine to schedule after the data-correctness items above
LOW	Retire the orphaned `api/leads.php` once its logic is ported, and the unused duplicate `custom_requests` schema table	Pure cleanup — removes a second, disagreeing implementation so future changes can't be made to the wrong one

Every finding above is sourced to an exact file and line number during this audit and can be re-verified directly against the current codebase. No estimates or assumptions were made about behavior that wasn't traced in code.